

Physician Engagement Strategy

Building Medical Director Alignment & Referral Partnerships

THE 5 PHYSICIAN HESITATION BARRIERS

1. Prognostic Uncertainty

"I can't predict exactly when they'll die." Response: Discuss the clinical criteria and that certification is about trajectory, not precision.

2. Abandonment Concerns

"Hospice means giving up." Response: Emphasize hospice as active comfort care and that you remain involved as attending.

3. Family Pressure

"The family isn't ready." Response: Offer to facilitate goals-of-care conversations; share family satisfaction data.

4. Time Constraints

"I don't have time for the paperwork." Response: Highlight that hospice handles 90% of documentation and coordination.

5. Knowledge Gaps

"I'm not sure about the criteria." Response: Provide LCD reference cards and offer brief in-service education.

5-STEP PHYSICIAN ENGAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

Step 1: EDUCATE

Provide clinical criteria resources, LCD guidelines, and prognostication tools. Position yourself as a resource, not a salesperson.

Step 2: ESTABLISH CREDIBILITY

Share your medical director credentials, clinical team qualifications, and outcome data from similar patient populations.

Step 3: OFFER SUPPORT

Offer to conduct family meetings, provide 24/7 clinical backup, and handle care coordination. Remove burden, don't add it.

Step 4: BUILD PARTNERSHIP

Propose regular case reviews, IDT participation, and open communication channels. Make collaboration easy.

Step 5: CONTINUOUS REFINEMENT

Provide feedback on patient outcomes, family satisfaction, and process improvements. Demonstrate ongoing value.

[TIP] CME OPPORTUNITY

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Offer to sponsor or facilitate CME-eligible education on palliative care, hospice criteria, or goals-of-care conversations. This positions you as an educational partner, not just a vendor.